

Nine Layers. Your AI Is Ready. Your Business Model Isn't.

The diagnostic framework behind Dead Model Walking and Dead Gods Walking

Most companies treat their agentic AI problem as a pricing problem. **Pricing is one layer.** Rebuild pricing alone and you haven't adapted, you've repriced. The commercial operating model has nine layers. Only one of them is pricing.

THE NINE LAYERS

- 01 Value Metric Alignment — what you charge for no longer matches what the agent delivers
- 02 Revenue Architecture — how revenue is structured, recognised, and forecasted under outcome-based delivery
- 03 Pricing — the layer everyone starts with, and the one that gets all the attention
- 04 Packaging & Entitlement — what's bundled, gated, and included as agents blur product boundaries
- 05 Metering & Usage Tracking — the infrastructure to measure what an agent actually did
- 06 Compensation Design — sales comp built for seat-based deals breaks under consumption or outcome pricing
- 07 Operational Infrastructure — the systems that support the new model, not just the pricing table
- 08 Customer & Value Communication — how you prove value delivered, not seats occupied
- 09 Reported Metrics — the board and investor metrics that still assume the old model

THE CONFESSION

Your pricing model is a confession of how you actually think about value. If it hasn't changed since before agentic AI, neither has your understanding of what you're selling.

Developed across advisory work with PE and VC-backed SaaS businesses navigating the agentic transition, and detailed in **Dead Model Walking** and **Dead Gods Walking** (Fessal Rahman, The Agentic Commercial Model series).